

Carol Simmons's Care Plan

From Dr. Desai · Visit on Tue, Sep 22

Hi Carol, it was so good to meet you. This plan starts with small steps in activity, nutrition, sleep, connection, and stress. Please get your kidney blood test about 1 week before your next visit. I'll see you on Tue, Oct 20 by video to check your weight and blood pressure and look at your food journal.

Activity

- **Start with 10-minute sessions of low-impact activity 5 days this week.** A short walk on flat ground, a recumbent bike, or water aerobics all work. Add a few minutes each week as you feel comfortable. Wear supportive shoes.
[Physical activity for seniors: Benefits, guidelines, and how to start safely](#)
- **Do strength exercises 2 days this week, with a rest day between.** Try chair squats, wall push-ups, and calf raises holding the counter. Aim for 2 sets of 10 at a comfortable effort. Bold's seated classes count.
[Strength classes with Bold](#)

Why? Regular movement helps your blood sugar and protects your bones. Strength keeps your muscles strong as you lose weight and supports your independence.

Nutrition

- **Aim for 25–30 grams of protein at each meal.** Good sources include eggs, Greek yogurt, chicken, fish, beans, and tofu. A protein shake can fill the gap if a meal falls short.
[The protein guide for adults 60+](#)
- **Drink 64 ounces of water each day.** That's about 8 cups. Try a full glass before each meal, and limit caffeine after noon.
[Nutrition for seniors: Your guide to healthy eating as you age](#)
- **Keep a photo food journal for the next 2 weeks.** Snap a quick picture of each meal and snack. We'll look at it together at your next visit.

Why? Enough protein helps protect your muscles as you lose weight. Water supports your energy and digestion. Your journal helps us fine-tune your plan together.

Sleep

- **Keep the same bedtime and wake time 7 days a week, even on weekends.** Avoid caffeine after noon, and wind down with breathing or light stretching in the evening.

[Better sleep for seniors: 8 simple habits to improve sleep quality](#)

Why? Steady sleep supports your blood sugar, mood, and energy.

Social connection

- **Try 1 group activity this month.** Water aerobics at a senior center or a group class at your church are good options. Moving with others can make both feel easier.

[How to cope with loneliness: Small steps to feel less alone as you age](#)

Why? Staying connected can ease worry, lift your mood, and keep you motivated to stay active.

Stress & mood

- **Practice 5 minutes of belly breathing when you feel the urge to snack in the evening.** Put one hand on your chest and one on your belly. Breathe in through your nose for 4 counts, then out for 6.

[Mind-body classes with Bold · How to manage stress & anxiety](#)

Why? Calming down in the moment can curb evening snacking and help you sleep.

Questions? Call your care team at (424) 577-5266. If this is a medical emergency, call 911.